Mehta concluded that the reason the Jan Sangh was not growing was because of deeper strategic failures: too much dependence on floating voters, no mass base among the working classes, lack of contact with the masses and an inability to use power to infiltrate institutions. These lessons, which he drew from the Communist Party, are all significant in contemporary politics too. Mehta forcefully argued that the Jan Sangh was too dependent on white-collar office-goers, small traders, upper middle-class intelligentsia and professionals. These voters 'were uncertain … hence are carried away by the winds blowing at the time of elections'. This is what happened in Lucknow, where the Jan Sangh's candidate, Radhey Shyam, lost his security deposit. 'In Amritsar, Ludhiana, Jullunder, Ambala, also white collared floating voters shifted again to Congress.' The Communist consolidation, on the other hand, was based on its focus on an 'illiterate, uneducated but faithful class'. The Jan Sangh 'never concentrated its strength on Harijans, backward class, oppressed people, slum dwellers or other toiling masses', Mehta said. In terms of voting numbers, these groups mattered much more. In many ways, he was setting the template for what became the BJP's greater mobilisation in the 1990s, and especially later under Modi and Shah.

The third lesson that Sangh leaders drew was that too much intellectualism lost it votes. Election reverses taught its top brass that focusing on esoteric intellectual issues did not mean anything to voters. As Mehta memorably put it:[114]

As soon as the Jana Sangh worker is elected to assembly or parliament he goes to the hungry, roofless, and half-naked masses and says, 'We shall sever diplomatic relations with China', 'We shall recognise Dalai Lama as the head of the Government in Exile in for Tibet', 'Recognise Formosa', 'Recognise Israel', 'Forge Better Relations with South-East Asian countries', 'Tit for Tat policy with Pakistan', 'Abrogate section 370 of the Indian Constitution giving special status to Jammu and Kashmir', 'Make Hindi national and official language', 'Crush Naga and Mizo rebels': as if by shouting the above slogans the down trodden masses will be uplifted …